Proverb on Restorative Justice: Nguihaowada

Resource Identifier: CULT-PROV-002

English Translation: A Person Cannot be Drowned for a Mistake

Category: Proverb | Subcategory: Justice

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul

Contributor / Source: Traditional Legal Lore (Kasomwoshi 1991) (Documented in Hao Tangkhul Chanjam)

License: Traditional Oral Heritage (Permissions: community_authorized)

Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Customary legal dispute resolution

---

Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Original saying: 'Nguihaowada masi kongra li machikhai paimana.' Emphasizes that traditional Tangkhul customary jurisprudence values restitution, reform, and reconciliation over cruel or irreversible punishment.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Nguihaowada masi kongra li machikhai paimana."

English Translation & Meaning:

"A person cannot be drowned in the river for committing a mere mistake."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

Quoted in Hangva council deliberations to balance justice with compassion and restitution.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Hangva Council, Disputing Parties, Community Mediators